



BODY LANGUAGE

Using Language: Explore Body Language

No words. Still a story.

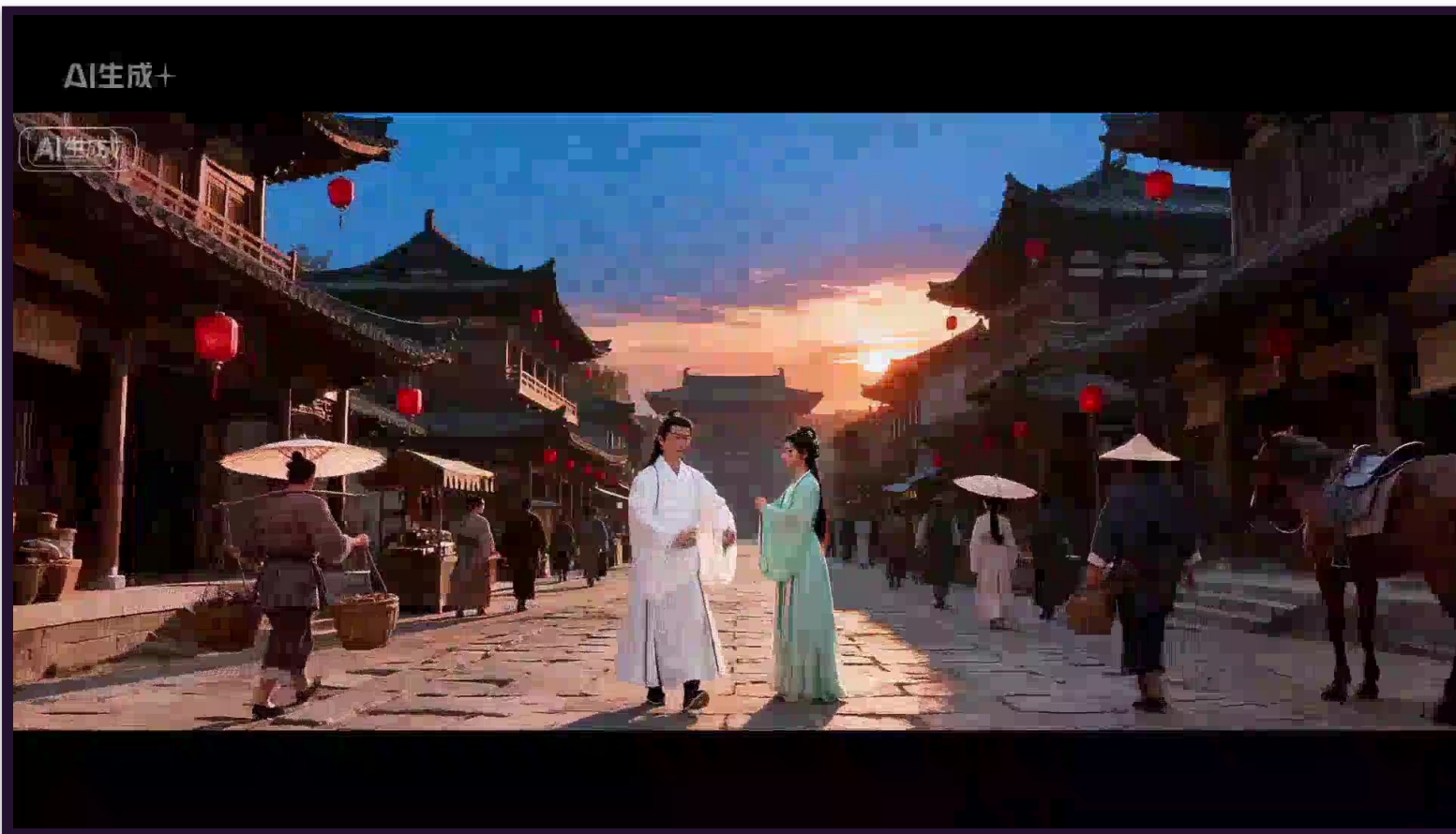
Can you read a scene before
you hear a word?

Learning objectives

By the end of the class, students will be able to:

- | | | |
|----|------------------|---|
| 01 | Recognize | Recognize the application of body language in different scenes. |
| 02 | Clarify | Use sentence patterns for asking for and giving clarification in communication. |
| 03 | Express | Use body language in communication to express one's thoughts and emotions. |
| 04 | Infer | Make correct inferences in listening passages. |

Body Language in Chinese Culture



- 01 Which gestures can you see?
- 02 What might each gesture communicate?
- 03 How do culture and context help?

Three ways our bodies speak

Body language: gestures, facial expressions and body postures



Gesture / hand signal

Hands communicate a message.



Facial expression

Faces communicate an emotion.



Body posture

The whole body communicates an attitude.

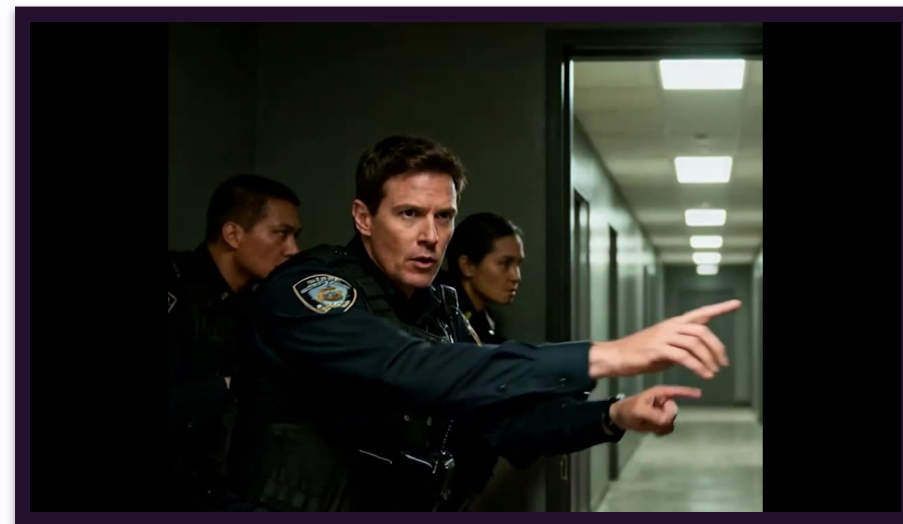
Observe the hands, the face and the whole body together.

When do gestures do the talking?

Discuss when and where people need to use body language to communicate.



**Charlie Chaplin's
silent movies**



Policemen catching criminals in action movies

Activity 1 · Listen for main idea

LISTEN



Listen to the conversation and fill in the blanks.

Q1 · What was the man doing?

The man was telling his friend to meet him for lunch down the street in 20 minutes by sending him secret _____.

hand signals

Q2 · How did he get the idea?

He got the idea from an _____.

action movie

Q3 · What has the woman been doing lately?

The woman is taking _____.

acting classes

Q4 · What is the woman learning?

The woman is learning how to use _____ to _____.

body language / express herself

Tip: focus on “who” and “what”.

Activity 2 · Listen for details

LISTEN



Listen to the first part. Choose the right answers to complete the chart.

The police leader used hand gestures to...

Tell them

_____ were in the house.

B · how many bad guys

Give instructions on

_____ and _____.

D · who should go where
C · what they should do

Outcome

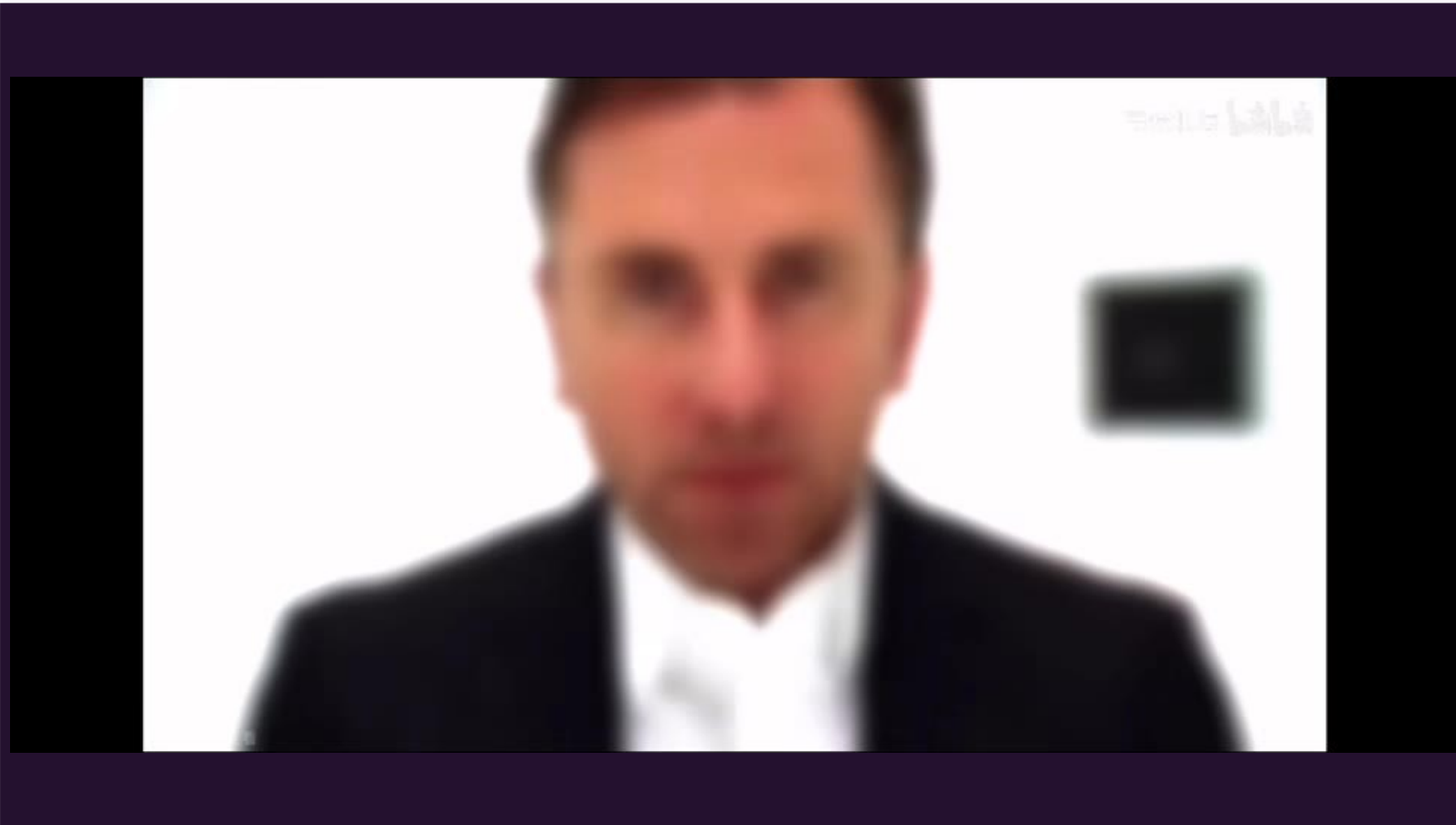
Take the _____ by surprise.

A · criminals

Function 1 · To Pass Information

Options: A. criminals B. how many bad guys C. what they should do D. who should go where

Read clues. Check your interpretation.



What will the police do after catching the criminals?

What's the function of body language in this process?

Function 2
To Tell Truth

Activity 3 • Listen for inference

LISTEN



Listen to the second part. Are these correct inferences from the conversation?

- 01 The woman thinks body language cannot be used to express complicated things.
- 02 The woman admires Charlie Chaplin for his skill.
- 03 The woman is not very confident about using body language.

Tips for inferring

Sometimes things are not said directly. Guess the meaning, relationship or context by:

- Draw conclusions from background information.
- Look at clues that tell you the context.
- Use logic to work out the meaning.

Listen → Evidence → Inference

LISTEN



Listen to the second part. Are these correct inferences from the conversation?

01 The woman thinks body language cannot be used to express complicated things.

EVIDENCE

It's really difficult if they want you to express something complicated without saying a word. But I'm slowly getting better at it.

FALSE

“Difficult” does not mean “impossible”; “getting better” shows progress.

Listen → Evidence → Inference

LISTEN



Listen to the second part. Are these correct inferences from the conversation?

02 The woman admires Charlie Chaplin for his skill.

EVIDENCE

Yeah, he was a real master. Everyone in my class loves his movies.

TRUE

“A real master” and “loves his movies” show admiration.

Listen → Evidence → Inference

LISTEN



Listen to the second part. Are these correct inferences from the conversation?

03 The woman is not very confident about using body language.

EVIDENCE

We actually had to watch some of his movies and act out some scenes. I was such an amateur.

TRUE

Calling herself “an amateur” suggests a lack of confidence at that point.

What emotions can movement convey?

As actors, what do Charlie Chaplin and the woman convey through body language?



Humour



Sadness



Distress



Thoughtfulness

Function 3 · To Convey Emotions

Explore body language in Chinese traditions

Zuoyi 作揖

Bow with Folded Hands

Politeness, respect, greeting, gratitude, self-humility; harmonious and orderly social relationships.



Lanhuazhi 兰花指

Orchid Finger

Beautiful, elegant, graceful; emotions, social status, subtle beauty and artistic conception.



Yunshou 云手

Cloud Hands

Slow, flowing; inner peace, harmony, Yin-Yang balance; overcoming hardness with softness.



Be a Cultural Ambassador!

Work in pairs. Create and act out a short dialogue to introduce one traditional Chinese body language to a foreign friend.

A Student A

A foreign friend who is curious about Chinese culture.

ASK FOR CLARIFICATION

“What do you mean by...?”

“What does this gesture mean?”

B Student B

A Chinese student who introduces a traditional body language to Student A.

CHECK & EXPLAIN

“So, you mean...?”

“Actors use it to convey...”

A dialogue that makes meaning clear

Example: Student B is performing a traditional body language.

A Hi! What do you mean by making that gesture? It's beautiful!

B Oh, this? This is called "Lanhuazhi," or "Orchid Finger" /'ɔːkɪd/, in Peking Opera.

A Orchid Finger? What does this gesture mean?

B It's not just a pointing gesture. Actors use it to convey the emotions of a lady, like shyness and joy.

A I see. So, you mean it's like a tool for telling a story without words?

B Exactly!

A That's amazing. Thank you for the clarification!

Choose a gesture. Build your dialogue.

Zuoyi 作揖

Bow with folded hands

Politeness, respect, greeting, gratitude, harmony.



Lanhuazhi 兰花指

Orchid finger

Beautiful, graceful; emotions, social status and the inner world.



Yunshou 云手

Cloud Hands

Slow, inner peace, Yin–Yang balance; overcoming hardness with softness.



NAME THE GESTURE → SHOW IT → EXPLAIN ITS MEANING → CHECK UNDERSTANDING

More than “stop” or “go”

Three universal functions of body language:

**To Pass
Information**

**To Tell
Truth**

**To Convey
Emotions**

Body language does more than say “stop” or “go.” Its real power lies in expressing the full range of human emotions, making it a universal language.

**Yet, every culture paints this code with its own colors. Now, it's our turn.
Let's move with the flow of Cloud Hands, gesture with the elegance of Orchid Finger,
and share the story of China through how we stand, move and greet.**

Check your progress

Finish the form by yourself. Check whether you have obtained the learning objectives of this class.

Learning objectives	I can do it well ★★★	I need to improve ★★	I have difficulties ★
1. Recognize the application of body language in different scenes.	☐	☐	☐
2. Use sentence patterns for asking for and giving clarification in communication.	☐	☐	☐
3. Use body language in communication to express one's thoughts and emotions.	☐	☐	☐
4. Make correct inferences in listening passages.	☐	☐	☐

Choose honestly. Set one goal for your next conversation.

Keep observing. Keep expressing.

A · Observation Diary

Observe the body language in a Chinese film or drama. Analyze what they intend to convey. Then submit your observation diary.



B · Dubbed Video

Observe and analyze the body language in a Charlie Chaplin movie, and then dub your own voice for a video clip.



Use movement to share the story of China.